

THOMAS S. RYAN, LT. COL. AIR ATTACHE

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AF FORM 112 REPLACES AF FORM 112, 1 OCT 32, WHICH MAY BE USED

~~SECRET~~

Air Force—US, 1955, 7-10, 10-14

(F... TUP CLASSIFICATION SECRET)

30 April 1959

30 April 1953

P.O. #15401
ASHEVILLE, NC 28813

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Excerpts

SUPPLEMENT TO AF FORM 112

ORIGINATING AGENCY

US AIR ATTACHE

REPORT NO.

IR 193-55

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QUOTED below is the cable classified Top Secret which was sent to Hqs. USAF on 13 Oct 55. USAIRA control number is C-103 and text follows:

" MIAC. TO: DIA; WASH. DC. NOFORM. USAF handle as OPERATIONAL IMMEDIATE. USAF CRYPTO PASS TO CINCUSAFE AND USAIRA MOSCOW. THREE RELIABLE US OBSERVERS, SENATOR RICHARD RUSSELL, LT. COL. E.U. HATHAWAY, ARMY, MR. ROBEN EFRON, VISITED PRAGUE 12-13 OCT. ARRIVING DIRECT FROM KIEV, VIA BAKU, TIFLIS, DNIEPERPETROVSK, BLACK SEA AREA, AND REPORTED FOLLOWING TO USAIRA AND USARMA.: ON 4 OCT. 55 AT 1910 HOURS BETWEEN ATJATY AND ADZHLIABUL, TEN MINUTES BY RAIL AFTER DEPARTING ATJATY IN TRANS CAUCASUS REGION, TWO ROUND AND CIRCULAR UNCONVENTIONAL AIRCRAFT RESEMBLING FLYING DISCS OR FLYING SAUCERS WERE SEEN TAKING OFF ALMOST VERTICALLY ONE MINUTE APART. DISC AIRCRAFT ASCENDED NEAR DUSK WITH OUTER SURFACE REVOLVING SLOWLY TO RIGHT AND WITH TWO LIGHTS STATIONARY ON TOP NEAR MIDDLE PART. SPARKS OR FLAME SEEN COMING FROM AIRCRAFT. NO PROTRUSIONS SEEN ON AIRCRAFT WHICH PASSED OVER OBSERVERS' TRAIN. BOTH FLYING DISC AIRCRAFT ASCENDED RELATIVELY SLOWLY TO ABOUT 6000 FEET, THEN SPEED INCREASED SHARPLY IN HORIZONTAL FLIGHT BOTH ON NORTHERLY HEADING. FLYING ATTITUDE OF DISC REMAINED SAME DURING ASCENT AS IN CRUISE, LIKE A DISCUS IN FLIGHT. TWO OPERATING SEARCHLIGHTS POINTING ALMOST VERTICAL SEEN NEAR TAKEOFF AREA LOCATED ABOUT 1-2 MILES SOUTH OF RR LINE. AFTER SIGHTING SOVIET TRAINMEN BECAME EXCITED AND LOWERED CURTAINS AND REFUSED PERMISSION TO LOOK OUT WINDOWS. US OBSERVERS FIRMLY BELIEVE THESE UNCONVENTIONAL AIRCRAFT WERE GENUINE SAUCER OR DISC AIRCRAFT. USAIRA RATES INFO B-2. ON 9 OCT. 55. AT DNIEPERPETROVSK AIRFIELD, HATHAWAY REPORTED

8P

USAF Lt.Col. THOMAS S. RYAN, U.S. Air Attache to Czechoslovakia;

The Significance of This Report...is Remarkable and lends Credence to many "saucer" Reports.

COUNTRY OF ACTIVITY REPORTING CZECHOSLOVAKIA		REPORT NO. IR 193-55		(Leave blank) 3	
AIR INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT					
COUNTRY OF AREA REPORT CONCERNING USSR		DATE OF INFORMATION 4 OCT. 55		T. S. RYAN 1.	
ACTIVITY SUBMITTING REPORT US AIR ATTACHE		DATE OF COLLECTION 13 OCT. 55		SRI STATUS (If applicable) TIC 6244 CANCELED/COMPLETE	
PREPARING INDIVIDUAL LT. COL. THOMAS S. RYAN		DATE OF REPORT 14 OCT. 55		SRI NO. CANCELED/INCOMPLETE	
NAME OR DESCRIPTION OF SOURCE LT. COL. E.U. HATHAWAY		EVALUATION B-2		SRI NO. CANCELED/INCOMPLETE	
				ADDITIONAL INFORMATION OR (Date) ACTIVE	
REFERENCES (State Subject, previous reports, etc., as applicable) BAIR 3A; 2T2; 3A3; 13A13; 3A15. USAIRA CABLE (TS) C-103 dtd 13 OCT. 55					
SUBJECT (Descriptive title. Use individual reports for concrete subjects) OBSERVATIONS OF TRAVELLER IN USSR					
SUMMARY (Give summary which highlights the salient features of narrative report. Begin narrative text on AF Form 112 unless report can be fully stated on AF Form 112. List inclusions, including number of copies) This report contains an eye witness account of the ascent and flight of an unconventional aircraft in the Trans Caucasus region of the USSR. This aircraft was reported by three highly reliable United States observers who were travelling by rail at the time of the sighting. The three observers were firmly convinced that they saw a <u>genuine flying saucer or flying disc</u>. Two sightings occurred at 1910 hours on 4 Oct. 55 between ATJATI and ADZHELJABUL, ten minutes by rail after departing ATJATI. One disc aircraft ascended almost vertically, at a relatively slow speed with its outer surface revolving slowly to the right, to an altitude of about 6000 feet where its speed then increased sharply as it headed north. The second flying disc was seen performing the same actions about one minute later. The take-off area was about 1-2 miles south of the rail line where two searchlight <u>0</u> beams were seen pointing up almost vertically. All other observations given to USAIRA in Prague by the three visitors, 12-13 Oct 55,					

RECOMMEND COMPLETE DEBRIEFING OF RUSSELL GROUP UPON RETURN AND SUGGEST COMMENDATION FROM D/I FOR EFFORTS. RUSSELL GROUP DEPARTED PRAGUE ABOARD SWAISSAIR FOR ROME 13 OCT. (Signed) T.S.RYAN." 8c

On 12 Oct. 1955 at about 2145 hours, Sen. Russell, Lt. Col. E.U. Hathaway, U.S. Army staff officer assigned to Senate Armed Forces Committee, and Mr. Ruben Efron, Committee Consultant, arrived at Wilson (Hlavni) Station in Prague, having come direct from Kiev. Their rail route from Kiev brought them to COP, at the eastern border of Czechoslovakia, where they observed the RR gauge switching operation from the Russian broad gauge to the Czech standard gauge. Upon arrival at the RR Wilson Station, the Russell group was met by the acting Chief of Mission, Mr. Harold Vedler, and the USAIRA. We escorted the group to the US Residency where they were to spend the night. It was evident that they had seen much and had been to places in Russia and possibly in Czechoslovakia where US observers had not been, at least for a good many years. Sen. Russell stated that he had been in Prague once before in 1927, and was anxious to see some familiar places. After arrival at the Residency and dinner, Lt. Col. Hathaway expressed a desire to report something of the utmost importance to the USAIRA, "something you may not believe, but something that we've been told by your people (USAF) doesn't exist." I suggested that we not discuss anything at the Residency because of the absence of security precautions but suggested that we meet early the next morning in my office together with Col. Thomas Dooley, the US Army Attache. Lt. Col. Hathaway said he was anxious to report his observation and that he had witnesses, fortunately, in Sen. Russell and Mr. Efron. 2

We met at 0900 on 13 Oct. in the larger office of the Army Attache and proceeded with the debriefing and adequate safeguards for talking. Present were: Lt. Col. Hathaway, Mr. Efron, Col. Dooley and myself. Col. Dooley and I took notes and provided paper for sketches. Sen. Russell was busy with the Chief of Mission and was unable to attend. Due to the departure time of the group, we were unable to spend more than one hour talking, the interview ending about 1600. Col. Hathaway did most of the explaining and answering with Mr. Efron supplementing and adding support. 9

Lt Col. Hathaway proved to be an excellent observer and Mr. Efron had kept detailed notes which he referred to for times and places.

Hathaway led off with "I doubt if you're going to believe this but we all saw it. Sen. Russell was the first to see this flying saucer and he called us to the window, and we both saw the second one (pointing to EFRON who nodded yes). We've been told for years that there isn't such a thing but all of us saw it, including Sen Russell." (It was emphasized that Sen. Russell saw the first flying saucer or flying disc ascend and pass over the train on a northerly course, taking off from the left side of the train's direction, which places the take-off area on the south side of the RR line on which they were travelling.)

I stated that I don't disbelieve anything after having been in Czechoslovakia for 17 months. The following raw notes are quoted with my additional comments after:

1. "Two flying saucer type aircraft were seen between two railway station stops after we left BAKU."
2. "It was after we left ATJATY, we were there at 1900 and we saw the aircraft at 1910. The next place we saw was ADZHIJABUL." (Efron's notes.)
3. "They took off straight up and then the speed increased greatly as they moved straight ahead, horizontally, and disappeared to the right of the train." (Questioning revealed that the angle of ascent was not exactly "straight up" but rather in a slight arc just off the vertical line.)

4. "The whole object whirled and then levelled and zoomed off at very high speed." (Questioning revealed that the outer surface of the object revolved slowly in a clockwise direction or to the right, with the rate of ascent being relatively slow in comparison to the high speed which the object took off at when it reached altitude.) 8D

5. "The take off was at an angle to about 2000 meters." (Both objects were said to have ascended almost vertically to an approximate altitude of 6000 feet before sharply increasing speed in level flight.)

6. "They were seen out of window on left side of train."

7. "Two searchlight were seen pointing at an angle near where the saucer took off." (The angle was nearly vertical and evidently, I gathered, that the angle of one searchlight beam was nearly vertical approximating the arc which the disc ascended to 6000 feet, while the second searchlight beam was pointing at another spot. Lack of time prevented complete clarification of the searchlight beams. Dusk was falling at the time of sighting.)

8. "Some sparking or flame came out bottom as craft rose."

9. "After we saw the two discs, the Soviet trainmen became excited, closing curtains and telling us that we were not allowed to look out of windows." (The behavior of the trainmen was such as to indicate that the US passengers had seen something that they were not supposed to see.)

10. "Approximately one minute elapsed between the first and second takeoffs of the aircraft." (It was explained that Sen Russell had seen the

11. DELETED

12. "There were two lights towards the inside of the disc which remained stationary as the outer surface went around." (Both agreed firmly on this point.) "The lights sat near the top of the disc." (If a line representing the diameter of the disc were divided into three segments, the lights would have been located at the two points of division between the middle segment and the two outside segments i.e. see sketch drawn with aid of Mr Efron.) 11



13. "The aircraft was circular." "The aircraft was round." "It resembled a flying saucer." "It seemed to be the shape of a discus, round and circular- revolving clockwise or to the right." (It was definitely round or at least circular in the eyes of these two observers, containing no protrusions or "sticks" or bulges. No estimate could be obtained from either observer re thickness or diameter.)

14. "There was no noticeable color" (It was stated that dusk prevented any color impressions.)

15. "After reaching 2000 meters, it whipped off at a great speed from our left to our right, or towards the north from the south." (Speed differential was very noticeable between ascent and level flight speed.)

16. "We could see the take-off on the horizon to our left or south of our train."

17. "Outer part revolved slowly to right." (There seemed to be a different impression of the disc's movement while climbing and after assuming level flight, with the terms "revolving slowly" used for the climb and the term "whirring" for the cruising flight.)

13. "The disc rose in the same position as it was in when it sped away." The flying attitude of the flying disc was said to resemble a discus in flight.) 8E

USAIRA COMMENT: I believe that further debriefing of all three US observers in a more relaxed atmosphere and with more time would produce much more valuable technical details than the hurried interview above.

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AF 1 OCT 55: 112a

REPLACES AF FORM 112-PART II, 1 JUN 55,
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U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1955-45172-1

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